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JEE MAIN 2027

STARTER HANDBOOK

The Complete Guide for the January 2027 Session

16.05 L

candidates raced JEE Main 2026

Jan 22-30

2027 Session 1 exam window

2.5 L

advance to JEE Advanced

20

chapters, zero filler

INSIDE

The 16 September 2026 NTA calendar, decoded
Registration walkthrough for the October window
Percentile, normalisation and the 2026 cutoff data
Physics-Chemistry-Maths playbooks, unit by unit
The 16-week sprint plan to 22 January 2027
JoSAA, CSAB and the JEE Advanced bridge

Contents

Ch.	Chapter	What it covers
1	The Announcement That Starts Your Clock	The 16 September 2026 NTA calendar and what it fixes
2	What JEE Main Actually Is	Papers, institutes, two sessions, best-of-two scoring
3	The Exam, Question by Question	Pattern, marking, languages, test-day mechanics
4	Percentile and Normalisation, Explained	How 300 marks become a rank, with 2026 data
5	Who Can Sit: Eligibility Rules	Attempts, the 75% rule, subject combinations
6	The Numbers That Define the Race	2026 participation, cutoffs, the 2.5 lakh pool
7	Registration: The October Window	Documents, fees, the form step by step, 12 mistakes
8	The Syllabus, Unit by Unit	All 53 units across Physics, Chemistry, Maths
9	The Physics Playbook	19 units, grouped, sequenced, with method
10	The Chemistry Playbook	Physical, inorganic and organic strategy
11	The Mathematics Playbook	14 units and the calculus core
12	The 16-Week Sprint to 22 January	Week-by-week plan, two tracks
13	Mock Tests and the Error Log	The 3:1 rule and post-test analytics
14	Boards and JEE Together	Protecting the 75% requirement
15	Session 1, Session 2, or Both?	A decision framework
16	After the Exam	Answer keys, results, JoSAA and CSAB counselling
17	The JEE Advanced Bridge	The top 2,50,000 rule and eligibility
18	Free Official Resources	What to use and what to ignore
19	Twenty Questions, Answered Straight	FAQs from real aspirants
20	The Master Checklist	Everything, in order, on two pages

How to use this handbook

Read chapters 1-7 this week: they cover everything time-sensitive. Chapters 8-11 are your subject maps for the next four months. Chapters 12-15 run your calendar. Everything after that is reference for February, April and June 2027. Every fact in this book carries its official source; a full list is on the last page.

CHAPTER 1

The Announcement That Starts Your Clock

On 16 September 2026, NTA published its examination calendar for the December 2026 to March 2027 window. If you are in Class 12, or repeating, this one page is your starting gun.

The National Testing Agency released its examination calendar on 16 September 2026, covering tests scheduled from December 2026 through March 2027. For engineering aspirants, the headline is simple: **JEE Main 2027 Session 1 will be held on 22, 23, 24, 28, 29 and 30 January 2027, with 31 January kept as a buffer date.** You get one of those six days, one shift, three hours. The countdown you should be running in your head is to 22 January 2027, not to some vague 'next year'.

The calendar comes with two caveats NTA itself states plainly. First, the dates are tentative and may change for administrative, academic, statutory or logistical reasons. Second, the calendar is not the notification: the detailed Information Bulletin, with application dates, fees, eligibility fine print and exam-city rules, is published separately, historically alongside the opening of registration. Neither caveat is a reason to wait. Every recent cycle has held to the announced exam window, and your study plan should anchor to it.

The full official timeline, as it stands

Event	Date	Status
NTA examination calendar published	16 September 2026	Confirmed, NTA calendar
Session 1 registration opens	October 2026 (expected)	Awaiting Information Bulletin
Session 1 registration closes	November 2026 (expected)	Awaiting Information Bulletin
Form correction window	December 2026 (expected)	Pattern from 2026 cycle
City intimation slip	January 2027 (expected)	3-4 days pattern, prior cycles
Admit card	January 2027 (expected)	3-4 days before exam, prior cycles
Session 1 exam	22-24 and 28-30 January 2027	In NTA calendar; 31 Jan buffer
Session 1 answer key and result	February 2027 (expected)	Pattern from 2026 cycle
Session 2 registration	Late January-February 2027 (expected)	Pattern from 2026 cycle
Session 2 exam	April 2027 (expected)	First week, per current cycle pattern
Session 2 result	April-May 2027 (expected)	2026 result came 20 April

Every row marked 'expected' follows the pattern of the 2026 cycle, where Session 1 applications opened on 31 October 2025 and the exam ran from 21 to 29 January 2026. Treat those as planning estimates, not promises. The two rows you may take as near-certain are the exam window itself and the fact that registration opens in October. That gives you roughly four weeks, at most, from reading this page to the moment the form goes live.

The one action for this week

Open jeemain.nta.nic.in and create nothing yet, but bookmark it along with nta.ac.in. Locate the 'Public Notices' section. From the first week of October, check it every two days. Registration windows for JEE Main have historically run about four weeks, and the last 48 hours are notorious for server load. You want your form submitted inside the first week.

One more date belongs on your wall even though it belongs to a different exam body: the Joint Entrance Examination (Advanced) 2027, the IIT entrance that draws its eligibility from JEE Main ranks, is expected to follow its usual rhythm with registration around April 2027 after the JEE Main results. Chapter 17 covers the bridge. For now, know that a strong January session is what buys you that option.

CHAPTER 2

What JEE Main Actually Is

Before strategy, get the machine straight: what the exam is for, what it admits you to, and how the two-session system works in your favour.

The Joint Entrance Examination (Main) is a national computer-based test run by the National Testing Agency. It does three jobs at once. It is the admission test for the NIT+ system: the National Institutes of Technology, IITs, Schools of Planning and Architecture, and other Centrally Funded Technical Institutes, whose seats are allocated through the Joint Seat Allocation Authority (JoSAA) on the basis of JEE Main ranks. It is the qualifying gate for JEE Advanced, the IIT entrance, which draws its candidates from the top of the JEE Main merit list. And its Paper 2 is the route to B.Arch and B.Planning programmes across the country.

Many state and private universities also accept JEE Main scores for their own B.Tech admissions, so the exam travels well beyond the institutes named on its own website. One exam, three doors.

The three papers

Paper	For	Structure	Marks
Paper 1 (B.E./B.Tech)	Engineering admissions; JEE Advanced gate	Physics, Chemistry, Maths; 25 questions each; computer-based	300
Paper 2A (B.Arch)	Architecture	Maths and Aptitude online; Drawing part on paper	400
Paper 2B (B.Planning)	Planning	Maths, Aptitude and Planning questions, online	400

This handbook concentrates on Paper 1, which is what the overwhelming majority of the 16 lakh-plus candidates write. If you are aiming for architecture, Paper 2A is your paper: its Mathematics section follows the same pattern as Paper 1, the Aptitude section tests drawing sense and visual reasoning, and two drawing questions are evaluated out of 100 marks with no negative marking. Appearing for both 2A and 2B extends your sitting to three and a half hours.

Two sessions, best score kept

Since 2022, JEE Main runs twice a year: a January-February session and an April session. The rules are generous. You may sit one or both. If you sit both, NTA considers your better total score for the merit list. Neither attempt is wasted: in the 2026 cycle, 8,61,343 candidates registered for both sessions, which tells you how routine the two-attempt path has become.

The January session is also, quietly, the JEE Advanced qualifier. The Advanced eligibility list is drawn after both sessions conclude, using each candidate's best score, but a strong January result means you spend March and April deciding whether to consolidate or chase a higher percentile instead of panicking. Chapter 15 works through the session decision in detail.

What your score buys

- **A JEE Advanced seat at the table.** In 2026, the General-category qualifying percentile for Advanced was 93.4123549, roughly the top 6.6 percent of candidates.

- **NIT+ admissions.** NITs, IIITs and other government-funded institutes allocate seats through JoSAA on JEE Main rank alone, no Advanced needed.
- **State and private university admission.** Scores are widely accepted outside the JoSAA system too.
- **A four-year head start on self-knowledge.** The January session, taken seriously, is the most honest diagnostic of where you stand relative to a lakh-scale field that money cannot buy.

The 75% rule, stated once and clearly

Appearing in JEE Main has no minimum Class 12 percentage. But admission to NITs, IIITs and CFTIs requires 75% aggregate in your Class 12 board examination (65% for SC, ST and PwD candidates), or a position in the top 20 percentile of your board. The same rule governs IIT admission at the seat-acceptance stage. Many aspirants discover this in July, when it is too late to fix. Chapter 14 is the countermeasure.

CHAPTER 3

The Exam, Question by Question

Three hours, 75 compulsory questions, 300 marks. Know the shape of the paper so well that nothing on exam day is new except the questions.

Paper 1 is a computer-based test of three hours (four hours for eligible PwD candidates). Each of Physics, Chemistry and Mathematics carries 25 questions worth 100 marks: Section A has 20 multiple-choice questions, Section B has 5 numerical-value questions. Every question is compulsory. This is the single most consequential pattern change of recent years: until 2024, Section B offered 10 numerical questions of which you attempted any 5. Since 2025, you attempt all 5, and a wrong numerical answer costs you a mark, exactly like a wrong MCQ.

The marking scheme

Question type	Correct	Wrong	Unattempted
Section A: MCQ (4 options, one correct)	+4	-1	0
Section B: numerical value	+4	-1	0
Paper 2A drawing questions	Evaluated out of 100	No negative marking	-

Two consequences follow. First, there is no skip-to-safety strategy in Section B anymore; a guessed numerical with a wrong answer costs the same as a wrong MCQ. Second, the paper punishes panic more than ignorance. A candidate who answers 55 questions at 85% accuracy scores 168; a candidate who answers 70 at 65% accuracy scores 126. Accuracy is not a virtue in this exam, it is the strategy.

Thirteen languages, one paper

The exam is administered in English and Hindi, plus Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Odia, Punjabi, Tamil, Telugu and Urdu. You choose your medium during registration; the question interface lets you switch and compare translations during the exam. Choose the language you think in, not the one that sounds more serious.

What the test centre will feel like

- **No calculator, virtual or physical.** NTA has clarified this explicitly. Your mental arithmetic and approximation habits are part of the syllabus whether you like it or not; Chapter 11 has drills for this.
- **Face authentication.** Identity verification matches the photograph from your application with your face at the centre. Carry two passport-size photographs as a contingency, as UPSC-style face-scan failures are handled with an undertaking and photo.
- **A three-hour window in one of six days.** Your date and shift are allotted by NTA; you cannot choose them. In 2026 the exam ran across roughly 323 cities.
- **Rough sheets.** You get sheets for calculations, collected at the end. Nothing goes home with you, so transcribe nothing you need later.
- **The interface.** Question palette, mark-for-review, and answer-and-marked-for-review states. Practise on the official mock interface (Chapter 18) until navigation is muscle memory.

The 75-question arithmetic

Maximum marks are 300. In the April 2026 session, the 99th percentile needed roughly 165 marks in the toughest shift and about 196 in the easiest. Read that again: around 62% of full marks in a hard shift put you in the top 1%. You do not need to be perfect. You need to be reliably right on what you attempt.

CHAPTER 4

Percentile and Normalisation, Explained

Your result is not a mark. It is a position. Understanding the difference changes how you should prepare and how you should read every mock score.

JEE Main runs across many shifts over several days, and no two question papers are equally difficult. NTA's solution is the percentile score. Your raw marks are converted, shift by shift, into a number between 0 and 100 that says what share of candidates in your shift scored at or below you. The formula, published by NTA, is:

Percentile = $100 \times (\text{number of candidates in your session with a raw score equal to or less than yours}) / (\text{total candidates who appeared in your session})$

The highest scorer in each shift gets 100.0000000, whatever their raw marks were. This is why a 285 out of 300 was a 100 percentile in one April 2026 shift while another shift saw perfect 300s: the percentile only ever compares you to your own shift's field. Your All India Rank is then assigned by ordering every candidate on their best total percentile across sessions.

Why raw marks mislead, in 2026 numbers

After the April 2026 session, NTA published a rare and clarifying dataset. To reach the 99th percentile, a candidate needed about 165 marks in the most difficult shift but as many as 196 in the easiest one: a 31-mark swing for the identical outcome. At the 98th percentile the spread was 27 marks, and at the 97th, 26 marks. Only two shifts saw candidates score a full 300. NTA's conclusion, and ours: comparing raw marks across shifts is meaningless, and panicking because a friend in another shift scored 'higher' is wasted adrenaline.

The tie-break ladder

Percentiles are computed to many decimal places, but ties still occur. They are resolved in a fixed order: the candidate with the higher Mathematics percentile ranks higher; if still tied, the higher Physics percentile; if still tied, the higher Chemistry percentile; if still tied, the older candidate. It is a small thing, but it is why subject-wise percentiles appear on your scorecard at all.

How to read your own scorecard

- Four NTA percentile scores: Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, and total, each to several decimals.
- Your category and All India Rank appear once the final merit list is published after Session 2.
- The JEE Advanced qualifying line is itself a percentile, announced per category with the Session 2 result. For 2026 it was 93.4123549 for General.
- The best of your two session totals is what counts. A weak January score does not drag down a strong April, and vice versa.

The scale of one percentile point

With roughly 16 lakh unique candidates in 2026, one full percentile band contains on the order of 16,000 candidates. The gap between 98.9 and 99.4 is not a rounding error; it is thousands of ranks. When you set a target, set it as a percentile with a decimal, and treat every mock as an attempt to move the decimal.

CHAPTER 5

Who Can Sit: Eligibility Rules

The rules are short, and each one ends an aspirant's season every year. Read all of them before you let yourself plan around one of them.

The rules for appearing

- **No age limit.** NTA imposes no upper or lower age for appearing in JEE Main. Institute admission can carry its own conditions, which the Information Bulletin governs.
- **Qualifying examination.** You must have passed Class 12 (or an equivalent recognised examination) in 2025 or 2026, or be appearing in 2027. For B.E./B.Tech, Physics and Mathematics are compulsory along with one of Chemistry, Biology, Biotechnology or a technical vocational subject.
- **Attempts.** You may appear in both sessions of each year's exam, in each of the years you are eligible. Your eligibility window is tied to your Class 12 year, not to a count of sittings.
- **Documents.** Aadhaar-based identity is the default; the bulletin provides alternatives for special cases.

The admission-side rules that ambush people

Appearing is one thing; using the rank is another. Three admission rules cause the most damage because aspirants treat them as fine print:

Rule	Applies to	The trap
75% aggregate in Class 12 (65% for SC/ST/PwD), or top-20 percentile of your board	Admission to NITs, IIITs, CFTIs; IIT seat acceptance	A great rank with 71% in boards is an unusable rank. It surfaces in counselling, after results.
Subject combination: PCM plus one of Chemistry/Biology/Biotechnology/vocational	B.E./B.Tech admission	Schools sometimes label streams in ways that hide a missing subject. Verify now, with your school, not in June.
JEE Advanced has its own attempt and age rules	IIT admission	Maximum two attempts in two consecutive years, plus an age condition. Chapter 17 covers it fully.

Check your board percentage this month

If your Class 12 pre-boards and school exams put you under 75%, that is a known, fixable problem today and an unrecoverable one in June. Chapter 14 gives boards and JEE preparation a combined weekly schedule precisely because the two exams are one system, not two rivals.

CHAPTER 6

The Numbers That Define the Race

You cannot calibrate effort against an exam you have not sized. Here is the 2026 cycle, in the numbers NTA itself published.

The 2026 cycle is the most recent complete dataset, and it is a big one. For Paper 1, 13,55,293 candidates registered for the January session and 13,04,653 appeared, a 96.26% attendance. The April session drew 11,10,904 registrations with 10,34,330 appearing. Across both sessions, the unique candidate pool was 16,04,854 registrations and 15,38,468 appearances. Roughly 8.6 lakh of those candidates, more than half the field, sat both sessions.

The 2026 cycle at a glance

Indicator	2026 cycle figure	Source
Session 1 registered / appeared	13,55,293 / 13,04,653 (96.26%)	NTA conduct data
Session 2 registered / appeared	11,10,904 / 10,34,330	NTA conduct data
Unique candidates, both sessions	16,04,854 / 15,38,468	NTA conduct data
Sat both sessions	8,61,343	NTA conduct data
Qualified for JEE Advanced	2,50,182	NTA Session 2 result notice
General qualifying percentile (Advanced gate)	93.4123549	NTA cutoff notice, April 2026
Session 2 result declared	20 April 2026	NTA

The qualifying percentiles for JEE Advanced

The percentile needed to enter the top 2.5 lakh moves with difficulty and field size. The General-category line has sat in the low-to-mid 93s for three straight cycles: 93.2362181 in 2024, 93.1023262 in 2025, and 93.4123549 in 2026. Reserved category lines run lower; in 2025 they stood at 81.32 for EWS, 79.43 for OBC-NCL, 61.15 for SC and 47.90 for ST. The 2026 category-wise figures are in the official cutoff notice on the JEE Main website; the lesson from the trend is not the third decimal, it is the direction: the gate has been inching up.

What percentile maps to what outcome

Exact mappings shift every year with the field, but the 2026 data supports honest planning bands:

Total percentile band	Rough position in the 2026 field	What it realistically opens
99.5+	Top ~8,000	Top NITs and IIITs in open branches; strong Advanced position
98.5 - 99.5	Top ~25,000	Most NITs, competitive branches at good IIITs; Advanced comfortably
95 - 98.5	Top ~1,20,000	NIT+ system broadly in play; Advanced qualified
93.4 - 95	The Advanced qualifying band	Advanced eligible; GFTIs and newer NITs

Total percentile band	Rough position in the 2026 field	What it realistically opens
Below 93.4	Majority of the field	State and private colleges accepting JEE Main scores; Session 2 becomes the project

The bands above are orientation, not gospel; branch and category change them substantially. Use them to pick a target with a decimal, then work backwards through your mock trend. A candidate at 91 in November needs about two percentile points by late January, which is a specific, plannable amount of improvement, not a vague 'study more'.

The 2,50,000 number

JEE Advanced eligibility is capped at the top 2,50,000 candidates in Paper 1, split by category: 40.5% Open, 10% GEN-EWS, 27% OBC-NCL, 15% SC and 7.5% ST, with 5% horizontal PwD reservation within each. With 15.38 lakh appearing in 2026, that is roughly the top 16% of the field. Every percentile point between 93 and 95 moves you thousands of places inside or outside that line.

CHAPTER 7

Registration: The October Window

The form is not hard; it is unforgiving. This chapter is your dry run, so that the real one takes forty minutes instead of four days.

Registration for Session 1 is expected to open in October 2026 on jeemain.nta.nic.in, the exam's official website. The 2026 cycle's Session 1 form opened on 31 October 2025 and ran about a month, with a correction window afterwards. Nothing about the process is conceptually difficult; what makes it painful is doing it in a hurry, on a phone, with a scanned photograph in the wrong size, at 11 PM on the last day. Do it in the first week, on a proper computer, with this chapter open.

Documents and details to have ready before the form opens

Item	Specification	Note
Passport photograph	JPEG, recent, plain background; 10-200 KB	Same photo works for admit card face-matching; keep several prints
Signature	JPEG, black ink on white; 10-100 KB	Scan at the specified size, crop tightly
Class 10 certificate	PDF for upload	Name and date of birth must match the form exactly
Aadhaar details	Number, for identity	Alternatives exist for special cases; see bulletin
Category certificate	OBC-NCL / EWS / SC / ST details	2026 cycle needed details, not uploads; rules can change in the bulletin
PwD certificate	If claiming the 4-hour sitting or reservation	Issue early; the process takes weeks, not days
Valid email and mobile	Yours, checked daily	All NTA communication lands here
Fee payment method	UPI, card, net banking	Save the confirmation page and payment receipt

The fee you should budget

The following fees are from the 2026 cycle, for Paper 1 at Indian test centres, per session; the 2027 Information Bulletin is the final word when it arrives.

Candidate category	Session fee
Male, General / Unreserved	Rs. 1,000
Male, GEN-EWS / OBC-NCL	Rs. 900
Female, and SC / ST / PwD / transgender candidates	Rs. 800 / Rs. 500 as per category

Note the fine print: female candidates of General, EWS and OBC categories paid Rs. 800, while SC, ST, PwD and transgender candidates paid Rs. 500. Sitting both sessions means paying twice. It is still, for a candidate below the Advanced line in January, the best Rs. 800-1,000 of the entire season.

The form, step by step

- 1 **Go to jeemain.nta.nic.in** and open the registration link for JEE (Main) 2027 Session 1 when it appears. Create a candidate account with email, mobile and a password you will not lose.

- 2 **Fill Part I:** nationality, state of residence, category, medium of schooling, diabetic status, exam medium choice, and whether you are appearing for Paper 1, Paper 2A, Paper 2B or a combination.
- 3 **Choose four exam cities** in order of preference, from the list in the bulletin.
- 4 **Enter academic details:** Class 10 marks and year; Class 12 details, or only the appearing year if you are in Class 12 now.
- 5 **Upload the photograph and signature** to the exact specifications, then complete the live photo capture section as prompted.
- 6 **Pay the fee online**, and on success, download the confirmation page. That PDF, plus the payment receipt, is your proof of registration. Save them in two places.

Twelve mistakes that cost people their season

- Name or date of birth not matching the Class 10 certificate exactly, including spacing and initials.
- Photograph with shadows, caps, or a background NTA rejects; the same photo later fails centre-level face matching.
- Wrong category selected, or an OBC-NCL / EWS claim without a valid, current certificate. A wrong claim discovered at document verification cancels admission even after allotment.
- Choosing only one exam city, or cities you cannot reach in January; the centre can be anywhere in your chosen list.
- Missing the appearing-for-Class-12 field, which forces awkward corrections later.
- Paying on the last day. Payment gateway failures on deadline day are the single most common registration catastrophe; NTA sometimes extends, sometimes does not.
- Not saving the confirmation page. No confirmation page, no proof, no admit card.
- Assuming registration for Session 1 covers Session 2. It does not; the April session needs a fresh application (details you entered are carried over, but the form and fee are new).
- Using a parent's email that is checked weekly. Admit card, city slip and correction notices arrive by email and SMS.
- Ignoring the correction window in December; it is your one sanctioned chance to fix the city, category or photograph.
- Registering through an 'agent' or cyber cafe that charges for it. The form is free apart from the fee, and your credentials are yours alone.
- Reading about JEE Main 2027 on random websites instead of the bulletin. Every year, candidates act on stale rules from a previous cycle.

Verification, the day after you submit

Log back in the next day and read your entire form once, top to bottom, as if grading a stranger's. Check the exam cities, category, paper combination and photograph. Then screenshot the confirmation page and email it to yourself. This five-minute habit has saved more candidacies than any coaching institute.

CHAPTER 8

The Syllabus, Unit by Unit

Fifty-three units across three subjects, from the official NTA syllabus. Read it once as a map; return to it monthly as a checklist.

The syllabus below follows the official NTA syllabus document published on the JEE Main website (the 2026 syllabus is the current operative version until the 2027 Information Bulletin). It is aligned with the rationalised NCERT Class 11 and 12 curriculum, which is itself a fact worth internalising: the NCERT textbooks are not 'basics' beneath this exam, they are the exam's native text.

Mathematics: 14 units

#	Unit	#	Unit
1	Sets, Relations and Functions	8	Integral Calculus
2	Complex Numbers and Quadratic Equations	9	Differential Equations
3	Matrices and Determinants	10	Coordinate Geometry
4	Permutations and Combinations	11	Three Dimensional Geometry
5	Binomial Theorem and its Applications	12	Vector Algebra
6	Sequence and Series	13	Statistics and Probability
7	Limit, Continuity and Differentiability	14	Trigonometry

Physics: 19 units

#	Unit	#	Unit
1	Units and Measurements	11	Electrostatics
2	Kinematics	12	Current Electricity
3	Laws of Motion	13	Magnetic Effects of Current and Magnetism
4	Work, Energy and Power	14	Electromagnetic Induction and Alternating Currents
5	Rotational Motion	15	Electromagnetic Waves
6	Gravitation	16	Optics
7	Properties of Solids and Liquids	17	Dual Nature of Matter and Radiation
8	Thermodynamics	18	Atoms and Nuclei
9	Kinetic Theory of Gases	19	Electronic Devices
10	Oscillations and Waves		

Chemistry: 20 units across three branches

Branch	Units
Physical (8)	Basic Concepts; Atomic Structure; Chemical Bonding and Molecular Structure; Chemical Thermodynamics; Solutions; Equilibrium; Redox Reactions and Electrochemistry; Chemical Kinetics
Inorganic (4)	Classification of Elements and Periodicity; p-Block Elements; d- and f-Block Elements; Coordination Compounds
Organic (8)	Purification and Characterisation of Organic Compounds; Basic Principles of Organic Chemistry; Hydrocarbons; Compounds Containing Halogens; Compounds Containing Oxygen (alcohols, phenols, ethers, carbonyls, carboxylic acids); Compounds Containing Nitrogen; Biomolecules; Principles Related to Practical Chemistry

How to use this map

Print this chapter, or copy the tables onto one sheet. Once a month, score every unit 0-2 (0 = untouched, 1 = studied but shaky, 2 = mock-tested). Your study plan in Chapter 12 is deliberately organised around these exact units, so the scoring feeds directly into the next week's choices. The syllabus is 53 units, not an infinite ocean; a unit a week is the whole thing, with weeks to spare.

CHAPTER 9

The Physics Playbook

Physics rewards depth and punishes shallow coverage more than either other subject. Here is how to sequence 19 units in 16 weeks.

JEE Main Physics questions are concept-first: they hand you a situation and expect you to see which two or three principles govern it. That is why the subject feels harder than its syllabus looks. The fix is sequencing and representation: build the subject as five blocks, in the order below, and insist on deriving rather than memorising each formula's conditions.

Block	Units	Why this order
Mechanics core	Units and Measurements; Kinematics; Laws of Motion; Work, Energy and Power	Everything later in physics assumes these; also the largest block of exam questions historically
Mechanics extensions	Rotational Motion; Gravitation; Properties of Solids and Liquids	Extends forces and energy to rotation and materials; common weak spot for aspirants
Thermal block	Thermodynamics; Kinetic Theory of Gases	Self-contained, formula-light, high accuracy returns; overlaps Chemistry thermodynamics
Waves and oscillations	Oscillations and Waves	Bridges mechanics and the electrical blocks; SHM reappears inside AC circuits
Electricity and magnetism	Electrostatics; Current Electricity; Magnetic Effects; EMI and AC; Electromagnetic Waves	The largest single cluster in the second half of the paper; dense and highly scoreable
Modern physics	Dual Nature; Atoms and Nuclei; Electronic Devices	The fastest marks per hour of study in the paper; near-mandatory scoring territory

Method for every unit

- 1 Read the NCERT chapter actively: work every solved example with a pen, before reading its solution.
- 2 Derive the core results yourself: the range formula, the moment of inertia, the lens maker's equation. Derivation is compression; memory is clutter.
- 3 Solve 25-40 Main-level questions on the unit, mixing MCQ and numerical types, timing yourself loosely.
- 4 Write a half-page 'conditions sheet': every formula with its validity conditions (ideal gas, point mass, thin lens, small oscillation). Most wrong answers in physics are correct formulas applied outside their jurisdiction.
- 5 Revisit the unit inside 10 days with 10 mixed questions, so it moves from recognising to retrieving.

The two most underpractised skills

First, estimation: with no calculator, you need one-significant-figure mental arithmetic, practised until it is boring. Second, unit hygiene: convert to SI before touching a formula, every single time. A large share of lost Physics marks in Section B (where you must type the number) is a units or significant-figures error, not a physics error.

CHAPTER 10

The Chemistry Playbook

Chemistry is the highest marks-per-hour subject in the paper, and the most neglected. Treat its three branches as three different sports.

Chemistry carries 100 of your 300 marks and, uniquely among the three subjects, a large share of it can be made near-certain before exam day. The three branches reward entirely different preparation behaviours, so train them separately rather than as one undifferentiated 'Chemistry' block.

Physical chemistry: the mathematics of chemistry

Units: Basic Concepts, Atomic Structure, Chemical Bonding, Thermodynamics, Solutions, Equilibrium, Redox and Electrochemistry, Chemical Kinetics. Physical chemistry is numerical and formula-driven, which makes it the closest thing in the syllabus to free marks for a well-prepared candidate. Master mole concepts early; nearly every numerical runs through it. Thermodynamics here also does double duty with the Physics thermal block; study them in the same fortnight and one revision serves both.

Inorganic chemistry: the reading subject

Units: Classification and Periodicity, p-Block, d- and f-Block, Coordination Compounds. Inorganic is the most memorisation-dense part of the syllabus, and the part where the NCERT textbook is most decisively the source: trends, reactions, colours and exceptions that appear in the paper are drawn from its pages. The method is small and frequent: short daily reading sessions, a running page of exceptions (the ones that break the periodic trends are the ones examined), and no marathon sessions, which do not stick.

Organic chemistry: the logic subject

Units: Purification and Characterisation, Basic Principles, Hydrocarbons, Halogen Compounds, Oxygen Compounds, Nitrogen Compounds, Biomolecules, Practical Principles. Organic looks like memory from the outside and is logic from the inside. Build it in strict order: bonding and electronegativity first, then reaction mechanisms (each with electron-flow arrows), then named reactions as consequences, never as isolated facts. If you can explain why a reaction proceeds, you own every variant of it the paper can dress it in.

A weekly operating rhythm

- Two physical-chemistry numerical sessions a week, 45 minutes each, timed.
- One inorganic reading session of 25-30 minutes daily rather than one long weekend block.
- One organic session focused on mechanisms and problem sets, with a growing one-page map of reactions.
- Every Sunday, 15 mixed questions across all three branches to keep retrieval interleaved.
- One error-log entry per wrong answer, in the format of Chapter 13.

The 15-mark floor

A candidate who has honestly finished NCERT Chemistry and one year of question papers has, historically, a defensible path to 70+ of the 100 Chemistry marks. No other 100-mark block in this exam offers that exchange rate. If your Chemistry section score in mocks is your weakest, the highest-return study hours of your week are already decided.

CHAPTER 11

The Mathematics Playbook

Fourteen units, one dominant cluster: calculus and algebra decide the Mathematics section, and the tie-breaks.

Mathematics in JEE Main is the largest section of the paper by time consumed and the most decisive in tie-breaks: when total percentiles tie, NTA first compares Mathematics percentiles. It rewards fluency, the kind built by volume plus error analysis, and punishes the 'I know the method' illusion, where you recognise the solution but cannot produce it cold.

The units in working order

Cluster	Units	Notes
Foundation algebra	Sets, Relations and Functions; Complex Numbers and Quadratic Equations	Quick wins; complex numbers pairs naturally with coordinate geometry
Counting and series	Permutations and Combinations; Binomial Theorem; Sequence and Series	Short chapters, high appearance rate; series questions reward pattern practice
Calculus core	Limit, Continuity and Differentiability; Integral Calculus; Differential Equations	The heart of the section and the tie-break engine; allocate the single biggest block of your calendar here
Geometry	Coordinate Geometry; Three Dimensional Geometry; Vector Algebra	Drawing-first subjects; 3D and vectors are short units with outsized returns
Mixed closing set	Matrices and Determinants; Statistics and Probability; Trigonometry	Determinants carry both direct questions and systems-of-equations tools; trigonometry is scaffolding for calculus and integration

Method that actually builds speed

- 1 For each unit, maintain a running sheet of problem archetypes (the 8-12 recurring question shapes for that unit). You are learning a catalogue of shapes, not a river of questions.
- 2 Do every practice set in timed bursts: 8 questions in 25 minutes. Untimed mathematics practice builds comfort, not speed.
- 3 After each burst, spend as long reviewing as solving. Every mistake enters the error log with its trigger, not just its correction.
- 4 Weekly, redo every error-log entry from the week before, from a blank page. If you cannot reproduce the fix, you have not made it.
- 5 Monthly, sit a full Mathematics section under exam conditions: 25 questions, 60-70 minutes, Section A and B discipline intact.

Numerical answers without a calculator

Section B requires you to type a number. Practise a personal convention now and never vary it: exact fractions only when the question demands it, else round as the question directs; write every intermediate value, never hold two digits in your head. Rough-sheet discipline is worth marks in this section, and rough-sheet chaos costs them.

CHAPTER 12

The 16-Week Sprint to 22 January

From the first week of October to exam day: one plan, two tracks, weekly checkpoints. Designed backwards from the paper, not forwards from hope.

From 1 October 2026 to 22 January 2027 there are 16 weeks. The plan below spends them in three phases: eleven weeks of building, three weeks of consolidation, and two weeks of rehearsal. It assumes 5-6 quality hours on school days and 8-10 on holidays for the Class 12 track, and 8-10 hours daily for the dropper track. If you are starting from a January-score base or with the April session as your primary target, the same structure stretches comfortably; the phases, not the dates, are what matter.

Phase 1: Build (Weeks 1-11, October to mid-December)

The building phase marches through the syllabus clusters of Chapters 9-11 in a fixed weekly template. Each week carries three subject days emphasised (Mathematics every single day), one mixed-practice day, one mock day and one review-plus-catch-up day. The template:

Day	Class 12 track (5-6 hrs)	Dropper track (8-10 hrs)
Mon-Wed-Fri	School + 2 hrs JEE (rotating weekly focus unit), 45 min Maths daily	3 hrs Physics/Chemistry cluster, 2 hrs Maths, 1 hr mixed numericals
Tue-Thu	School + 2 hrs JEE, board-homework absorbed into JEE units where possible	3 hrs alternate cluster, 2 hrs Maths, 1 hr previous-year questions
Saturday	4 hrs: full mock (3 hrs) + initial review	4 hrs full mock + full error-log session
Sunday	3 hrs: deep error-log review + weekly unit scoring + next week's plan	3 hrs error log + unit scoring + plan + one rest block

Weekly focus rotation across Phase 1 (one cluster in the spotlight each week, others maintained):

- 1 W1 Mechanics core (P) + mole concepts and atomic structure (C) + algebra foundation (M)
- 2 W2 Mechanics extensions (P) + bonding and periodicity (C) + counting and series (M)
- 3 W3 Thermal block (P) + thermodynamics and equilibrium (C) + limits and continuity (M)
- 4 W4 Oscillations and waves (P) + solutions, kinetics, electrochemistry (C) + differentiation and applications (M)
- 5 W5 Electrostatics, current (P) + p-block and coordination (C) + integration (M)
- 6 W6 Magnetism, EMI and AC (P) + organic principles and hydrocarbons (C) + integration and differential equations (M)
- 7 W7 EM waves, optics (P) + oxygen compounds (C) + coordinate geometry (M)
- 8 W8 Modern physics block (P) + nitrogen compounds, biomolecules (C) + 3D geometry and vectors (M)
- 9 W9 Full-syllabus gap week: weakest six units, chosen from your monthly scoring sheet
- 10 W10 Matrices, determinants, statistics, probability, trigonometry (M) + full Chemistry consolidation
- 11 W11 Remaining gaps closed; first full-syllabus mock; recalibrate target percentile

Phase 2: Consolidate (Weeks 12-13, late December)

- Two full mocks per week instead of one, both at your real exam shift's time of day.
- Daily error-log redo: every entry from Phase 1 that is still cold.
- Formula-and-conditions sheets compressed to one page per subject; revise from the page, not the textbook.
- NCERT Chemistry re-read for inorganic, once, cover to cover, in the last fortnight.

Phase 3: Rehearse (Weeks 14-16, January)

- Alternate days: full mock, then a light review day (2-3 hrs: error log, formula pages, one weak unit).
- In the final week, no new topics at all. New material in the last week trades confidence for nothing.
- Sleep at your exam-shift hours for the last five days. The exam is a three-hour performance; treat it like one.
- Keep your admit card, two photographs and ID ready the night before; the exam-day checklist is in Chapter 20.

If you are reading this in November or later

Compress, do not abandon. Keep Phase 1's rotation but run it at two clusters a week, cut each cluster's depth by a third, and keep the mock day sacred. A shorter honest plan beats a longer aspirational one you abandon in week three.

CHAPTER 13

Mock Tests and the Error Log

Mocks do not measure preparation; they manufacture it. The three hours matter less than the three hours after.

Every serious JEE Main candidate sits mocks; few extract what they are worth. The rule that separates the two groups is the 3:1 rule: for every hour of testing, spend three hours on the post-mortem. A mock review is not reading solutions. It is classifying every question into one of four buckets and acting on each differently.

The four buckets

Bucket	What it means	Action
Concept gap	You did not know the underlying idea	Back to the unit tonight; re-derive, then 10 fresh questions
Method gap	You knew the idea, not the technique	Add the archetype to your unit sheet; redo within 3 days
Silly error	You knew it and still lost the mark	Error log with trigger: misread sign, unit slip, calculation rush; weekly tally of triggers
Time loss	Right answer, wrong cost in minutes	Note the minutes spent; practise the archetype under a hard timer

The error log format that works

One entry per mistake, four lines, no exceptions: the question's source and number; what you did; what the correct move was; the trigger, in your own words. The log is not a diary of shame, it is your personal question bank of the exact things your own mind gets wrong. Redo entries weekly from a blank page. The aspirant with a 300-entry error log and honest redos is carrying a weapon into that exam hall that no fresh question bank can replace.

Reading the mock analytics

- Track three numbers per mock: total percentile (or score), attempted-vs-correct rate per subject, and time per subject.
- Attempted-vs-correct is the honest one. Below 80% accuracy in any subject means your attempt count is too high for your preparation level; the -1 marking is eating you alive.
- Watch for the classic inversion: Chemistry time leaking into Mathematics. Fix the order you attempt sections in and hold it for at least three mocks before judging.
- Use official previous-year papers (Chapter 18) as your calibration mocks; their difficulty is the real baseline, not any publisher's 'tougher-than-JEE' claim.

The percentile you should chase in mocks

Chase accuracy before percentile. In the 2026 data, 165 of 300 was a 99th percentile in a hard shift. That is roughly 42 correct answers with very few wrong. A 55-attempt, 85%-accuracy paper outperforms a 70-attempt, 65%-accuracy paper every single time this exam is conducted.

CHAPTER 14

Boards and JEE Together

The 75% rule makes your board exam part of your JEE preparation whether you plan for it or not. Plan for it.

NIT, IIIT and CFTI admission requires 75% aggregate in Class 12 (65% for SC, ST and PwD), or a top-20-percentile position in your board. IIT seat acceptance carries the same condition. Every year, a band of aspirants clears a strong rank and cannot use it. The problem is never difficulty; Class 12 boards do not out-difficulty a serious JEE preparation. The problem is that board-style answering, presentation, definitions, step-marking has its own craft, and it needs a small, scheduled allocation, not a panic in March.

The integrated operating system

- Treat NCERT as one shared syllabus, not two. Your Physics, Chemistry and Maths JEE study is simultaneously board study; the difference is depth and question style, not content.
- Once a fortnight, write one full board-style answer per subject: structured, defined, presented. Marking-scheme awareness is a skill you can hold in two hours a month.
- English and your fifth subject are where board percentages actually die. Give them two fixed hours a week from October; they ask for little, but they ask reliably.
- Use your school's pre-board exams as full dress rehearsals: sleep properly, take them seriously, and let the results tell you your realistic board percentage in January, when there is still time.
- If a pre-board puts you under 75%, escalate immediately: shift two more weekly hours to boards until the next school exam, and get your teacher's diagnosis of where the marks are leaking.

Two percentages, one season

For a dropper, this chapter is a reminder: your Class 12 percentage is already locked, and if it is below the admission line, the JEE Main rank alone will not carry you into an NIT. Check which board and which year's top-20-percentile cutoffs apply to you, and plan your institute list accordingly rather than discovering the rule in a JoSAA round.

CHAPTER 15

Session 1, Session 2, or Both?

The two-session system is the most under-used strategic lever in this exam. Here is the decision, made cleanly.

You may appear in one or both sessions; if you sit both, NTA keeps your better total score for the merit list. In the 2026 cycle, 8,61,343 candidates registered for both sessions. The default answer, for almost every candidate, is both: Session 1 is worth its weight as a real-percentile diagnostic and a dry run, Session 2 is worth it as the improvement play. The fee is a few hundred rupees per session. The asymmetry is total.

What each session is actually for

	Session 1 (January)	Session 2 (April)
Role	The diagnostic and the Advanced qualifier track	The consolidation and improvement play
Best if	You want an early honest reading, or Advanced eligibility to plan around	You are below your target band and have three more months to close it
Risk	Illness or a bad day costs you the early shot	Board practicals and board exams crowd March-April
History	2026: 13.55 lakh registered	2026: 11.11 lakh registered, 8.61 lakh of them repeats

The three honest cases

- **Class 12 student, strong preparation:** both sessions. Sit January at full seriousness; if it lands above your target, April becomes a choice; if not, it becomes your project.
- **Class 12 student, preparation behind schedule:** both, with expectations calibrated: January is the diagnostic, April is the real attempt, and the 16-week plan extends to a 28-week plan, which is a different, calmer book.
- **Dropper:** both, without discussion. Your entire year is priced in these two sittings, and the best-of-two rule is pure insurance.

The registration trap inside this decision

Session 2 requires a fresh application and a fresh fee. In the 2026 cycle, its window opened in early February with a reopening later in March. Mark the last week of January and the first week of February 2027 in your calendar now, in writing, as 'check the Session 2 notice', because a strong January score has made more than one family forget to register in time.

CHAPTER 16

After the Exam

The exam is half the process. Answer keys, results and counselling are their own discipline, with their own deadlines.

Answer keys and the challenge window

After each session, NTA publishes the provisional answer keys and your recorded responses, opens a challenge window (with a per-question fee, refunded if your challenge is upheld), then releases the final key. Check your responses against the provisional key the day it drops; challenges are only accepted inside the window, usually two to three days. The final answer key, not the provisional one, computes your result, and it has moved marks for many candidates in past cycles.

The result

Your scorecard shows the four NTA percentile scores (Mathematics, Physics, Chemistry, total) for the session. After Session 2, the consolidated result carries your best total, your All India Rank, and your position relative to the JEE Advanced qualifying cutoffs announced in the same notice. In 2026, the Session 2 result came on 20 April with 2,50,182 candidates qualifying for Advanced.

JoSAA: the joint seat allocation

Admissions to the IITs (on JEE Advanced ranks) and the NIT+ system (on JEE Main ranks) run through JoSAA, a fully online joint process conducted in multiple rounds shortly after results. The mechanics you must respect:

- 1 Registration on josaa.nic.in with your exam credentials, followed by choice filling: an ordered list of institute-and-branch combinations. Order is everything; the algorithm respects it literally.
- 2 Seat allotment in rounds. Each round offers you the best seat your rank, category and choices can carry at that point.
- 3 Your response to an allotment: freeze (accept), slide (same institute, better branch), or float (keep the seat, try for better elsewhere). Wrong willingness choices are the most common self-inflicted counselling wound.
- 4 Online document verification and fee payment within each round's window. Miss a window and the seat, and often the counselling run itself, is gone.
- 5 After the JoSAA rounds conclude, CSAB Special Rounds fill remaining NIT+ seats through a fresh registration on csab.nic.in with fresh choice filling; previous choices do not carry over.

Start your college list in February, not June

Choice filling under deadline pressure produces a list ordered by recency and anxiety. The calm way: in the weeks after the January session, build a spreadsheet of NITs, IIITs and GFTIs with your target branches, ordered by genuine preference, using last year's closing ranks only as a sanity check on reach, target and safe bands. When JoSAA opens, you transcribe a considered list in an hour instead of improvising one in a night.

CHAPTER 17

The JEE Advanced Bridge

The IIT door has its own five keys, and all of them must fit at once.

JEE Advanced 2027, expected to be conducted by IIT Delhi under the Joint Admission Board, is the IIT entrance. Its eligibility funnel starts inside JEE Main: the top 2,50,000 candidates in Paper 1 qualify, split by category as 40.5% Open, 10% GEN-EWS, 27% OBC-NCL, 15% SC and 7.5% ST, with 5% horizontal PwD reservation within each. In 2026, 2,50,182 candidates cleared the line, with the General-category qualifying percentile at 93.4123549.

The five criteria, all of which must hold

Criterion	Requirement for JEE Advanced 2027 (as per current rules)
Performance in JEE Main	Rank within the top 2,50,000 in Paper 1 (B.E./B.Tech)
Age	Born on or after 1 October 2002; five-year relaxation for SC, ST and PwD
Attempts	Maximum two attempts, in two consecutive years
Class 12	First appearance in Class 12 (or equivalent) in 2026 or 2027, with Physics, Chemistry and Mathematics
Earlier IIT admission	Not admitted previously to an IIT academic programme; specific withdrawal exceptions apply

Two clarifications prevent most of the confusion. The 75% board rule (65% for SC, ST, PwD, or top-20-percentile) is an admission-stage condition, not a condition for appearing in Advanced. And the two-attempt rule counts attempts in consecutive years, which is why a 2026 Class 12 student sitting Advanced 2026 has exactly one more shot in 2027.

The honest planning note

If January puts you inside the qualifying band, your March and April have two jobs: hold your Main percentile through the April session, and layer Advanced-style depth (multi-concept problems, longer derivations) onto the same syllabus. The two exams share a syllabus but not a temperament; Advanced rewards patience inside a question, Main rewards velocity across 75 of them. Practise both, deliberately.

CHAPTER 18

Free Official Resources

The best JEE Main preparation material in the country costs nothing. What to use, what to ignore, and in what order.

Resource	Where	How to use it
JEE Main previous-year papers with answer keys	jeemain.nta.nic.in	The single most important practice source; the last 4-5 years of papers are your calibration mocks
Official mock / practice interface	Linked from the NTA and JEE Main sites	Learn the CBT interface: palette, mark-for-review, section navigation, on-screen timer
Information Bulletin 2027 (when released)	jeemain.nta.nic.in	The only authoritative source for fees, eligibility fine print, exam cities and dates; read it end to end once
NTA public notices	nta.ac.in and jeemain.nta.nic.in	Registration, correction-window, admit-card and answer-key announcements land here first
NCERT Class 11-12 textbooks	ncert.nic.in (free PDFs)	The syllabus's native text, especially decisive for Chemistry; use actively with pen and paper
JoSAA and CSAB portals	josaa.nic.in, csab.nic.in	Seat-allocation rules, opening-and-closing ranks from past rounds, and the counselling schedule when live

What to ignore

- Telegram channels selling 'leaked papers' or 'confirmed dates'. NTA never pre-announces results, and leaks are a fiction that recurs every single cycle.
- Paid 'rank predictor' services with decimal-precision claims. The free percentile-to-rank arithmetic from official data is all the realism you need.
- Any third-party site that asks for your JEE login credentials for 'application help'. The form is free, and credentials are yours alone.
- Syllabus PDFs from random coaching sites; the official syllabus document on the NTA site is short, free and the only real one.

CHAPTER 19

Twenty Questions, Answered Straight

The questions every serious aspirant (or their parent) asks, with the answers the official record supports.

When exactly is JEE Main 2027 Session 1?

22, 23, 24, 28, 29 and 30 January 2027, with 31 January as a buffer date, per the NTA calendar published 16 September 2026. Your personal date and shift are allotted by NTA and shown on your admit card.

When does registration open?

October 2026 is the expected window, on jeemain.nta.nic.in, per the pattern of recent cycles (the 2026 form opened 31 October 2025). Await the Information Bulletin for the confirmed dates.

How many questions, and is there negative marking?

75 compulsory questions for 300 marks: 20 MCQs plus 5 numericals per subject. Both types carry +4 for correct and -1 for wrong; unattempted questions score zero.

Can I choose which questions to attempt in Section B?

No. Since the 2025 cycle, all 5 numerical questions per subject are compulsory, with negative marking, exactly like the MCQs.

Is there an age limit?

No age limit for appearing in JEE Main. Institute-level admission conditions are governed by the Information Bulletin.

Who is eligible for the 2027 exam?

Candidates who passed Class 12 in 2025 or 2026, or who are appearing in 2027, with Physics and Mathematics plus one of Chemistry, Biology, Biotechnology or a technical vocational subject.

What is the 75% rule?

Admission to NITs, IITs and CFTIs requires 75% aggregate in Class 12 (65% for SC, ST, PwD) or a top-20-percentile position in your board. It applies to admission, not to appearing.

Should I take both sessions?

For nearly everyone, yes: NTA counts your better score, and in 2026 over 8.6 lakh candidates took both. Session 2 needs a separate registration and fee, typically opening in February.

What percentile do I need for JEE Advanced?

The line moves each year with the field: General was 93.2362181 (2024), 93.1023262 (2025) and 93.4123549 (2026). Plan for the low-to-mid 93s or above.

How many candidates am I competing with?

The 2026 cycle saw 16,04,854 unique registrations, 15,38,468 appearances, and 2,50,182 Advanced qualifiers.

What rank does a 99 percentile mean?

Roughly the top 8,000-16,000 candidates depending on the year's field; each full percentile band holds on the order of 16,000 candidates at current participation levels.

Is a calculator allowed?

No. Neither a physical calculator nor an on-screen one is provided. Mental arithmetic and approximation are part of the tested skill.

Can I change my exam city after submitting the form?

Only within the correction window NTA opens after registration closes (December 2026 expected). After that, the admit card is final.

What if I miss the registration deadline?

Session 1 is gone for the year, and Session 2's window (around February) becomes your target. There is no late fee mechanism; the window is the window.

Is NCERT enough for Chemistry?

As the base, yes: the syllabus is aligned to rationalised NCERT, and inorganic especially is drawn from its pages. Add one serious question bank and previous-year papers and you have a complete Chemistry pipeline.

How different is JEE Advanced from Main?

Same syllabus core, different temperament: Advanced favours multi-concept, patient problem-solving; Main rewards speed and accuracy across 75 short questions. Only the top 2,50,000 in Main qualify for Advanced.

How does counselling work?

JoSAA runs online rounds allocating IIT seats (Advanced ranks) and NIT+ seats (Main ranks) against your ordered choice list; you respond with freeze, slide or float, and complete verification and payment inside each round's window. CSAB Special Rounds follow for vacant NIT+ seats.

What documents do I need at the centre?

Admit card, a valid photo ID, and two passport-size photographs (the same as your application photo), plus any PwD certificate if applicable. Check the admit-card instructions for the full list.

I am a dropper with below-75% boards. Can I still get an NIT?

Not through the main channel; the percentage condition applies at admission. Check whether your board's top-20-percentile cutoff from your Class 12 year clears your score, and plan your application list accordingly.

How current is this handbook?

Written in September 2026, verified against the NTA exam calendar of 16 September 2026, the official JEE Main syllabus, and NTA's published 2026 conduct and result data. The 2027 Information Bulletin, when it arrives, is the final word on every 'expected' date and fee.

CHAPTER 20

The Master Checklist

The whole handbook compressed into two pages of tick-boxes. Print this part.

This week (by 27 September 2026)

- Bookmark jeemain.nta.nic.in and nta.ac.in; diary a twice-weekly check of Public Notices from 1 October.
- Confirm your subject combination and eligibility with your school, in writing.
- Check your last board percentage / pre-board trend against the 75% line; escalate if short.
- Start your documents folder: photo, signature, Class 10 certificate, Aadhaar, category certificate if applicable.
- Set up the error log (any notebook or sheet; four lines per mistake) and take the diagnostic previous-year paper untimed.

October: register and launch Phase 1

- Register in the first week the form opens; verify the whole form the next day; save the confirmation page twice.
- Pay only the official fee; keep the receipt.
- Begin the Week-1 cluster of the 16-week plan; Mathematics gets a daily slot from day one.
- First full timed mock on 31 October, whatever your syllabus coverage; the baseline must exist before it can improve.

November-December: build and correct

- Hold the weekly template: 5 mocks in November, 5-6 in December, 3:1 review time each.
- Use the December correction window for city, category or photograph fixes.
- Monthly unit scoring (0-2) on all 53 units; the week-9 gap week follows the scores, not your mood.
- Pre-boards taken seriously as board rehearsals; board percentage checked again in January.

January: rehearse and sit

- Admit card out: verify date, shift, city, and travel plan the same day.
- Final week: no new topics; formula pages, error-log redos, sleep at exam hours.
- Exam-day kit ready the night before: admit card, ID, two photographs, water, permitted items per the admit-card instructions.
- After the exam: check the provisional answer key when it drops; use the challenge window if warranted; watch for the Session 2 registration notice in late January or early February.

February onwards: the second half of the season

- Register for Session 2 (fresh form, fresh fee) if it is in your plan; do not rely on memory, rely on the diary entry.
- Build the college-choice spreadsheet from JoSAA's past closing ranks.

- April: Session 2; then the consolidated result, Advanced qualification check, and JoSAA when it opens.
- Keep every credential, admit card and scorecard until admission is physically complete.

The one-sentence version of this entire book

Register in the first week of October, treat the 53 official units as the whole of your ocean, let the error log make your mistakes expensive only once, guard the 75% board line like a rank, and walk into 22 January with accuracy as the strategy. The rest is calendar.

Sources and Verification

Every date, figure and rule in this handbook was verified, in September 2026, against the following official or primary sources. Where a number comes from a coaching or news intermediary, the underlying document is an official NTA notice, and the intermediary is noted only as the access path.

Fact cluster	Source
JEE Main 2027 Session 1 dates (22-24, 28-30 January 2027; 31 January buffer)	NTA examination calendar published 16 September 2026; reported by Careers360, Jagran Josh and other outlets from the NTA notice
Expected registration windows (October 2026; February-March 2027)	Recent-cycle patterns reported by Careers360 and Collegedwar, pending the official 2027 Information Bulletin
Exam pattern, marking scheme, languages	JEE Main official website (jeemain.nta.nic.in) and the current Information Bulletin as reported by Careers360 and Aakash
2026 participation and conduct data	NTA conduct-data notices for the January and April 2026 sessions
Qualifying percentiles for JEE Advanced (2024-2026)	NTA cutoff notices with the Session 2 result, 20 April 2026, and prior cycles
Normalisation formula and April 2026 shift-difficulty data (165 vs 196 marks at 99th percentile)	NTA public clarification on percentile scoring, reported by Telegraph India Edugraph, April 2026
Syllabus (14 Mathematics, 19 Physics, 20 Chemistry units)	Official JEE Main syllabus document, jeemain.nta.nic.in
JEE Advanced eligibility (top 2,50,000; category split; age; attempts; Class 12 rules)	jeeadv.ac.in eligibility criteria and the JEE Advanced 2027 information published by Careers360
JoSAA and CSAB counselling process	josaa.nic.in and the CSAB Special Rounds 2026 Information Brochure, csab.nic.in
Fees (Rs. 1,000 / 900 / 800 / 500 per session, 2026 cycle)	JEE Main 2026 fee structure as reported by Careers360 from the official bulletin; confirm against the 2027 Bulletin

Official websites for your own verification: jeemain.nta.nic.in (JEE Main) · nta.ac.in (NTA) · jeeadv.ac.in (JEE Advanced) · josaa.nic.in (JoSAA) · csab.nic.in (CSAB) · ncert.nic.in (NCERT textbooks). This handbook is an independent study guide and is not affiliated with NTA, JoSAA or any government body.